

Odyssey OD2001 IR

Features: Infra-red communication, range of 2 meters, 15 hotkeys, on-board track pad, PS/2 interface, package includes a palm rest
Price: Rs 2,340 Contact: Compuage Infocom Ltd
Phone: 022-23842200 E-mail: info@compuageindia.com
Web site: www.compuageindia.com

The Odyssey OD2001 IR is a sleek, sophisticated keyboard with a black body and keys set in a tasteful dark grey. Mouse control is emulated via a track pad, provided at the upper right corner, with buttons simulating the left and right buttons. This infrared unit works at a distance of approximately 5 metres from the receiver (although the manual claims a safe distance of 2 metres). With a layout that emulates a laptop's keyboard (its width is less compared to normal keyboards), the Odyssey is a compact package that fits snugly on the lap of the typist. The keyboard weighs less than a kilo, while the base unit weighs less than 250 grams, making it quite easy to lug around. There are 15 special function keys—four for Internet functions, three for volume control, five for audio control, one key for power, another for standby and the last one for the alarm. You just need to plug the PS/2 connectors for the mouse and keyboard in the sockets and its

ready. No driver installation is required even for the 15 special keys. However, the price tag of Rs 2,340 takes some thinking.

Odyssey OD2001 IR B+	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Samsung Multimedia Keyboard SEM-M2A

Features: 20 hotkeys, PS/2 interface, palm rest not bundled
Price: Rs 300 Contact: Samsung Asia Pte Ltd
Phone: 022-22814886

Here is a keyboard that offers excellent build quality but is found lacking in the looks department. With around 20 additional programmable keys, the device offers both flexibility and comfort, since the keys are soft, silent and very easy on the fingers. The keyboard is quite heavy, making it more stable on the desk. A small form factor ensures that it occupies very little desktop space. It interfaces with the PC via the PS/2 port and a cable that is of sufficient length for most desk spaces. On the whole, this product from Samsung provides good value for money.

Samsung SEM-M2A B	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Odyssey OD2001 M1

Features: PS/2 interface, package includes a palm rest Price: Rs 585
Contact: Compuage Infocom Ltd
Phone: 022-23842200 E-mail: info@compuageindia.com
Web site: www.compuageindia.com

The Odyssey OD 2001 M1 is an ideal solution for those looking to buy a keyboard for multimedia applications, without burning a hole in the pocket. This keyboard is easy on the eye with a white and grey colour combination. The multimedia keys are neatly arranged on top and it has all the usual features, viz, Play/Pause, Volume-Up, Volume-Down and Mute for music lovers; and shortcut keys for Web browser, such as Search and Favorites and Power, Sleep & Wake.

The Odyssey OD2001 M1 is heavier than other keyboards, giving it desk stability, while the palm rest bundled affords good ergonomics. Installation is simple—plug the keyboard into a PS/2 connector and you are all set—no driver hassles, no special software needed for the multimedia keys. With a price tag of Rs 585, it makes a decent purchase.

Odyssey OD2001 M1 B	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Samsung PC Keyboard

Features: No hotkeys, PS/2 interface, palm rest not bundled
Price: Rs 300 Contact: Samsung Asia Pte Ltd
Phone: 022-22814886

The first thing that strikes you about the SEM-DT35N is its sleek black colour. The feel of the keyboard is very easy on the fingers and it doesn't offer any multimedia buttons, bringing its cost down to an affordable Rs 300. Borrowing a leaf off the weird book, the keyboard provides support for the Korean Hangul script. While this might seem like a good thing for the miniscule Indian populace that interacts with that language, to the rest of us the feature only serves to add a lot of visual clutter. What's worse is the decision to obscure the all important backslash key [\]: it is still there, but marking its position is the normal 'pipe' symbol and a weird looking symbol that remotely resembles a 'W'. A new user would be quite dismayed to find the all-important backslash key missing.

But its reasonable price makes it easy to overlook this fault—it's extremely difficult to find economical keyboards that look good and perform well. All said and done, Samsung sure has a pretty decent product on its hands.

Samsung PC Keyboard B+	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶